

The Dementia Caregiver's Handbook - Planning Sheets

Every planning sheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

Worksheet 5.1 - Our communication rules (fill in for the carers who share the work)

Situation	What works with our person	What does not
The repeated question		
"I want to go home"		
Refusing something (a wash, a tablet)		
An accusation		
Seeing or hearing something that is not there		
Getting the words out		

The daily routine planner

Time	Activity	Notes (what helps; what to avoid)
Waking		
Morning care (toilet, wash, dress)		
Breakfast and morning medicines		
Morning activity		
Mid-morning drink		
Lunch		
Rest		
Afternoon activity or outing		
Afternoon drink and snack		
Evening meal and evening medicines		
Quiet evening		
Bedtime routine		
Night (what to expect; what to do)		

The "About Me" sheet

Every future carer, day centre, hospital ward and care home will meet a person who cannot tell them who they are. This sheet does it for them. Fill it in together while you can, keep it with the person (a copy in the bag, one on the fridge), and hand it over to every new carer before they start.

About me	
What I like to be called	
Where I grew up, and my family	
My work, and what I was proud of	
People who matter to me (and who has died, so nobody tells me as news)	
My daily routine and the order I like things	
Food and drink I love, and cannot stand	
Music, programmes, hobbies, faith	
Things that upset or frighten me	
Things that calm me	
How I show I am in pain, cold, hungry, needing the toilet	
Glasses, hearing aids, dentures, walking aid	
Words and phrases I use, and what they mean	

Worksheet 7.1 - Personal care plan

Task	When and how often	What works for our person	Aids we have / need	Who helps
Washing				
Bathing or shower				
Dressing				
Toilet routine (prompt times)				
Continence products				
Teeth / dentures				
Hair, nails, feet				

Worksheet 8.1 - Food and drink diary

(three days, when weight or intake is a worry)

Day / time	What was offered	What was eaten (roughly)	Drinks (cups)	What helped or got in the way

Weight now: _____ on _____ Weight a month ago: _____ If it is falling, tell the doctor and ask for a dietitian.

The behaviour diary

Date / time	What happened (exactly)	What happened just before	Where, who was there	What we did	Result	Possible cause

Worksheet 10.1 - Our behaviour plan

The behaviour	Likely cause (from the diary)	What we do in the moment	What we changed to prevent it	Who we told (doctor / nurse)

Worksheet 11.1 - Home safety checklist

Area	Done	Needs doing	Who / when
ID card / bracelet; photo ready; neighbours told; safe- return scheme			
Door alarms / chimes; keys and coat out of sight			
Cooker shut-off / isolation; kettle; microwave			
Rugs, routes, night lights, grab rails, seat, shoes			
Medicines: blister packs, locked cupboard, list on fridge			
Driving: assessed / stopped; alternatives in place			
Money: authority in place; cards; call blocking; post			
Alarms tested; water temperature; key safe			

Worksheet 12.1 - What is normal for our person (so we can tell when it is not)

	Usual
Alertness through the day	
Walking and balance	
Appetite and drinks	
Toilet pattern	
Sleep	
Mood and behaviour	
Speech	
Temperature (if you take it), pulse, breathing	
Doctor's number / out-of-hours number / emergency	

Worksheet 13.1 - Legal and financial checklist

	Done	In progress	Who / notes
Power of attorney: finances			
Power of attorney: health and welfare			
Advance directive / living will			
Advance statement of wishes			
Will up to date			
Benefits claimed (person)			
Benefits claimed (carer)			
Bank arrangements (joint / third-party access / authority registered)			
Care funding advice taken			
Important documents in one place, and someone else knows where			

Worksheet 14.1 - Our help plan

Kind of help	Have it	Want it	Who to ask / next step	Cost or funding
Home care (hours, times)				
Day centre (days)				
Respite (regular; emergency)				
Dementia adviser / nurse				
Carer's assessment				
Sitting / befriending				
Meals / laundry / cleaning				
Carers' group				

Worksheet 15.1 - Care home visit checklist

	Home 1	Home 2	Home 3
First impression at the door: welcome, smell, noise			
Staff: numbers on the floor; how they speak to residents; turnover; dementia training			
Residents: occupied, dressed, clean, calm; interacting			
The manager: how long in post; how they answer "what happens when someone becomes aggressive?"			
Daily life: activities we saw happening; outside space; outings; music			
Food: menu, choice, help with eating, drinks offered			
Rooms: own things allowed; en-suite; safe; homely			
Health: doctor visits; nursing; medicines; end-of-life approach			
Family: visiting hours (should be open); involvement in care plans; how they tell us about changes			

Inspection reports and complaints			
Fees: what is included; what happens if money runs out; notice period			
Gut feeling: would I want to live here?			

Worksheet 17.1 - Our wishes for the end (with the person if possible; with the doctor)

Where they would want to be cared for at the end	
Who should be there; who should be called	
Treatments they would refuse (from the advance directive)	
Comfort measures that matter to them (music, faith, particular people)	
Resuscitation decision (discussed with the doctor on: ____)	
Hospital admission in the last stage: yes / only for comfort / no	
Funeral wishes	
The palliative care team's number	

The signs

Caregivers rarely notice their own decline, because it is gradual and because noticing feels like complaining. Tick the ones that are true this month:

	Yes
I sleep less than six hours most nights, or wake unrefreshed	
I have been ill more often than usual, or have an ache that will not go	
I have missed my own medical or dental appointments	
I have stopped seeing friends, or stopped an activity I loved	
I feel angry at the person I care for more days than not	
I cry easily, or feel numb, or both	
I drink more than I used to, or eat badly, or not at all	
I have thought "I can't do this any more" this week	
I feel guilty most of the time, whatever I do	
Nobody has asked how I am for a fortnight	
I have shouted at or been rough with the person, and hated myself	
I have had thoughts of harming myself, or of the person	

Four or more: you are carrying too much, and the rest of this chapter is for you. The last line, at any number: call your doctor today, and know that it is common, that it is the illness of exhaustion speaking, and that it has help.

Worksheet 18.1 - My own plan

My next time off (date, who covers)	
My regular slot (weekly)	
My next respite week (date)	
My own appointments booked (doctor, dentist, eyes)	
My daily walk (when)	
The person I tell the truth to	
The carers' group / helpline I will contact	
The standard I am lowering this week	
The sign that means I must ask for more help	

Care team contacts

Role	Name	Phone	Notes (hours, when to call)
Family doctor			
Out-of-hours / emergency			
Memory clinic / specialist			
Dementia adviser / nurse			
Social worker / care manager			
Home care agency			
Day centre			
Pharmacist			
Community nurse			
Occupational therapist / physio			
Palliative care team			
Lawyer / attorney			
Family: who to call first, second, third			
Neighbour with a key			

Medicines list (keep on the fridge and in your phone; update every change)

Medicine	Dose	When	What it is for	Started	Prescribed by	Notes (side effects; how they take it)

Emergency information sheet (for paramedics, hospital and any carer; keep with the About Me sheet)

Name, date of birth, address	
Diagnosis (type of dementia) and stage; other conditions	
Allergies	
Medicines (see list)	
Next of kin / attorney (name, relationship, phone)	
What is normal for them (speech, walking, alertness, continence)	
What helps when they are frightened	
Glasses / hearing aids / dentures / walking aid	
Advance directive / resuscitation decision: where it is	
Doctor's name and number	
Where the key safe is / who has a key	

Weekly carer's log

Week of	Nights disturbed	Hours of help received	Time off taken	Changes noticed in the person	Called the doctor?	How I am (0-10)

Print more copies of every sheet from the link at the front of the book.